

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Azure | Zero Trust | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience leading security operations, implementing security controls across hybrid cloud environments, and delivering security assurance across complex Microsoft and multi-cloud infrastructure. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) using Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Zero Trust architecture, Identity and Access Management (IAM), and vulnerability management. At University of the Arts London (UAL), I have overseen the security of an 8,000-user environment, led Security Operations Centre (SOC) functions including incident response under NIST 800-61, driven penetration testing and risk assessment activities, and ensured compliance with Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001 standards. I am seeking a senior security engineering role in a mission-driven public sector organisation where I can apply my technical leadership and security assurance expertise to protect critical financial and digital infrastructure.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, KQL (Kusto Query Language), Conditional Access
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID, Zero Trust architecture, IAM, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Endpoint and Infrastructure Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM), Tanium, Check Point Harmony firewall
- **Vulnerability Management and Security Assurance:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), penetration testing remediation, risk assessments
- **Incident Response and Threat Intelligence:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, SOC operations oversight, SOAR automation
- **Compliance and Governance:** ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, security policy development
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks, KQL-based detection engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst (Engineer) University of the Arts London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Lead the security engineering function across UAL's hybrid Microsoft and cloud infrastructure, serving as the security authority for change, design, and governance forums.
- Oversee Security Operations Centre (SOC) performance, managing alert triage, threat hunting, and incident response in accordance with NIST 800-61 and using MITRE ATT&CK for threat classification.
- Manage and optimise Microsoft Sentinel as the organisation's primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, developing KQL-based detection rules, custom analytic queries, and automated SOAR playbooks to improve response efficiency.
- Lead IAM and Zero Trust implementation through Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, ensuring least-privilege access across the organisation.

- Drive vulnerability management and security assurance activities, including penetration testing oversight with AppCheck and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), prioritising and tracking remediation with infrastructure teams.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) across 8,000+ endpoints, including detection policy tuning, threat intelligence integration, and CrowdStrike Insight threat hunting.
- Administer Microsoft Intune for Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance and Conditional Access integration.
- Maintain and enforce security policies aligned to Cyber Essentials Plus, ISO 27001, and NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), contributing to annual audit and certification activities.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns, reducing phishing susceptibility across the staff and student population.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Performed daily SIEM alert triage and security event investigation across Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender platforms, supporting the incident response lifecycle from detection through to containment and remediation.
- Managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across the enterprise, tuning alerts and managing exclusions to improve signal quality.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), configuring Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and identity governance controls for 8,000 users.
- Supported CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent deployment and policy administration, managing endpoint agent configurations and group policies.
- Managed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform, administering privileged session policies, onboarding accounts, and producing audit reports for compliance purposes.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning with Nessus and AppCheck, coordinating remediation with infrastructure and application teams in line with risk-based prioritisation.
- Authored and maintained PowerShell automation scripts for log analysis, account lifecycle management, and endpoint compliance validation.
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway configurations, enforcing anti-phishing, anti-malware, and data loss prevention policies.

IT Engineer, Security Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered security engineering across the company's SaaS cloud infrastructure, implementing endpoint hardening, network security controls, and access management governance.
- Implemented MFA and SSO policies to secure internal and customer-facing systems in line with Zero Trust principles.
- Supported vulnerability assessment and risk management activities, working cross-functionally to remediate identified security gaps.
- Managed IT security quality assurance and compliance activities in alignment with ISO 27001 internal security standards.
- Administered Mobile Device Management (MDM) policies for company-issued devices and configured security baselines for Windows endpoints.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led and maintained CISSP certification, demonstrating breadth of security expertise across all eight CISSP domains including Security and Risk Management, Asset Security, Security Architecture, IAM, and Security Operations.
- Drove Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment and detection engineering at UAL, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) through custom KQL analytics and automated SOAR playbooks.
- Oversaw Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 compliance activities, ensuring UAL met regulatory and government baseline security requirements.
- Implemented Zero Trust identity architecture via Microsoft Entra ID and Conditional Access for 8,000 users, reducing risk of identity-based compromise.

- Led penetration testing and Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) remediation programmes, tracking and closing vulnerabilities in coordination with infrastructure teams.
- Delivered phishing simulation and security awareness campaigns that measurably reduced susceptibility across UAL's staff population.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Bedford/Remote, UK)